

GVS GURUKULAM

Detailed Project Report

A Living Ecosystem for Holistic Education, Health, Culture and Conscious Living



1. Executive Summary

GVS Gurukulam is envisioned as the next chapter in a living lineage of Kalaripayattu, Kalari Chikitsa, Ayurveda and traditional knowledge. Building upon the legacy of Guru Veerasree Sami Gurukkal, Hindustan Kalari Sangam in Kozhikode and Kalarigram in Auroville, the project proposes an integrated campus for education, embodied practice, healing, research and service.

The vision is not simply to create a collection of buildings. GVS Gurukulam is conceived as a living ecosystem in which knowledge is learned through study, embodied through practice, deepened through experience and ultimately returned to society through service.

- Preserve traditional knowledge and living lineages.
- Educate future practitioners through immersive learning and practice.
- Heal through Kalari Chikitsa, Ayurveda and integrated wellness programmes.
- Serve individuals and communities through accessible knowledge and care.
- Connect traditional Indian knowledge with a contemporary and international context.

2. The Lineage and Foundation

Guru Veerasree Sami Gurukkal devoted his life to the practice, preservation and transmission of Kalaripayattu, Kalari Chikitsa and the spiritual study of Tantra Shaastra. His work established a foundation in which martial discipline, healing knowledge and inner development were understood as interconnected dimensions of human cultivation.

In the 1950s, Guru Veerasree Sami Gurukkal founded Hindustan Kalari Sangam in Kozhikode, Kerala, as a centre for Kalaripayattu, Kalari Chikitsa and Ayurveda.

The lineage is carried forward by his children, including Sri Laxman Gurukkal, who founded Kalarigram in Auroville in 2010 as an extension of this living tradition and as a bridge between traditional knowledge and global cultural exchange.

3. Kalarigram and the Next Chapter

Kalarigram has developed as a living field of practice centred around Kalaripayattu, Kalari Chikitsa, Tantra, Ayurveda and Natya Shastra. GVS Gurukulam represents the next stage of this vision: the development of a larger and more integrated environment capable of supporting long-term education, clinical healing, wellness programmes, research, cultural exchange and community service.

4. Vision

To establish a living Gurukulam that brings together embodied knowledge, health, healing, education, culture and conscious living in one integrated ecosystem.

The project seeks to create a place where traditional knowledge is neither treated as a museum object nor separated into isolated disciplines. Instead, the Gurukulam will support continuous exchange between the study of the body, the cultivation of health, philosophical knowledge, practical experience and service to others.

5. The Gurukulam Model

The educational philosophy is organised around transmission rather than information alone. Knowledge is developed through a continuous relationship between Shaastra (knowledge and study), Shastra (knowledge of the body and practice), Svasthyam (health and healing), lived experience and service.

- Living – Learning: knowledge is transmitted through an active environment of practice.
- Practice – Service: personal cultivation develops into responsibility and contribution.
- Knowledge – Experience: study is continuously tested and deepened through embodied experience.

6. Three Pillars of Practice and Service

6.1 Kalaripayattu & Kalari Chikitsa

Embodied Practice. Traditional Martial Art and Healing Therapies. Understanding the Body. Discipline. Strength and Transformation.

Kalaripayattu — Mastery of the Body

Kalaripayattu is an ancient discipline of movement, awareness and transformation. Through dedicated practice, students cultivate strength, flexibility, coordination, discipline and presence. The practice is not understood only as the study of combat, but as a path towards a deeper understanding of the body, mind and human potential.

Kalari Chikitsa — Healing of the Body

Kalari Chikitsa is a traditional healing practice rooted in a deep understanding of the body and movement. Through specialised therapies, massage and therapeutic practices, it supports recovery, mobility, strength and physical well-being. Practice and healing become one continuum: understanding the body, caring for it and supporting its natural capacity to move and thrive.

6.2 Ayurveda Gurukulam & Chikitsaalaya

Educating the new Generation of Healing Practitioners.

- Classical Learning (Shashtra)
- Practical Training (Anubhava)
- Research & Innovation
- Character & Seva

The Ayurveda Chikitsaalaya is envisioned as a space for authentic Ayurvedic treatment, Panchakarma and therapeutic practices, as well as preventive and lifestyle care.

6.3 Kalari Aarogyam & Svasthyam

Kalari Aarogyam & Svasthyam is envisioned as a personalised journey towards health, recovery and sustainable well-being. Bringing together the principles of Kalari Chikitsa, Ayurveda, therapeutic movement and embodied practice, this pillar creates space for deeper healing, rehabilitation, renewal and long-term health cultivation.

Programme Areas

- Healing and wellness retreats
- Therapeutic movement and rehabilitation programmes
- Kalari Chikitsa and Ayurvedic therapies
- Recovery and rejuvenation programmes
- Long-term health and lifestyle programmes

7. Key Activities

- Education & Training: long-term and short-term learning in Kalaripayattu, Kalari Chikitsa, Ayurveda and related traditional knowledge.
- Clinical Healing: therapeutic and healing services through Kalari Chikitsa and Ayurveda.

- Wellness & Retreats: structured programmes for recovery, rejuvenation, therapeutic movement and sustainable well-being.
- Research & Knowledge Exchange: documentation, study, collaboration and innovation rooted in traditional knowledge.
- Culture & Community: gatherings, demonstrations, cultural programmes and exchanges.
- Seva & Service: translating knowledge and institutional capacity into meaningful service.

8. Beneficiaries and Impact

- Students and practitioners: immersive learning and long-term skill development.
- Patients and individuals seeking care: traditional healing and therapeutic services.
- Wellness participants: structured retreats and longer-term health programmes.
- Researchers and institutions: opportunities for study and knowledge exchange.
- Local and wider communities: cultural continuity, education and service.

The long-term impact lies in the preservation of a living lineage while creating a contemporary platform for education, health and service.

9. Partnership and Funding Opportunity

GVS Gurukulam offers an opportunity for patrons, funding partners, institutions, researchers and collaborators to participate in the development of a long-term ecosystem for knowledge, health and service.

Support can contribute to campus infrastructure, teaching and healing facilities, practitioner capacity, research and knowledge exchange, programme development and long-term institutional sustainability.

The objective is not simply to construct facilities, but to establish an enduring ecosystem capable of carrying a living tradition forward while serving future generations.

10. Conclusion

GVS Gurukulam represents the continuation and expansion of a living lineage. Its vision brings together the mastery of the body, the healing of the body, the cultivation of health, the study of knowledge and the practice of service.

Rooted in the legacy of Guru Veerasree Sami Gurukkal and carried forward through Hindustan Kalari Sangam and Kalarigram, the proposed Gurukulam seeks to create an environment where traditional knowledge can continue to live, evolve through practice and contribute meaningfully to contemporary life.

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